QPCODE: 25900752

MAHATMAGANDHIUNIVERSITY,KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP(HONOURS) REGULAR /IMPROVEMENT/ REAPPEARANCE EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025

1st SEMESTER

Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) - MG1MDCBOT100, MG1MDCBBT100 - ECOTOURISM

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt atleast one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall Outcome attainability

Duration: 1 Hour | Max. Marks: 35

Part A Short Answers
Answer any 5 out of 8 Questions, Each Question carries 1 mark

1	Can you provide an example of a natural landscape in Kerala that attracts ecotourists?		[K] / [CO3]
		Kerala - Silent Valley National Park, Periyar Wildlife Sanctuary, Thenmala, (any one)	
2	Discuss the concepts and principles of ecotourism.		[A] / [CO3]
		Ecotourism's core concepts are conservation, community, and sustainable travel, guided by principles like minimizing environmental and cultural impacts, educating visitors, and providing direct financial benefits to local communities and conservation efforts.	
3	Define endemism.		[U] / [CO3]
		Endemism is the state where a species is native to a single, specific geographic location and is not found anywhere else naturally. This ecological phenomenon describes organisms that are restricted to a particular area, such as an island, a mountain range, or a specific region.	
4	What is meant by responsible marketing?		[U] / [CO1]
		Responsible marketing is an approach that prioritizes ethical, sustainable, and socially conscious principles in a company's promotional activities.	
5	Why determining carrying capacity is important in ecotourism planning?		[An] / [CO4, CO5]
		Determining carrying capacity is crucial for ecotourism planning to ensure sustainability by preventing negative environmental, social, and economic impacts.	
6	Name few ecotourism resources of India.		[K] / [CO3]
		Some of India's ecotourism resources include national parks like Kaziranga and Jim Corbett, natural areas such as the Kerala Backwaters and Sundarbans, and unique destinations like Spiti Valley and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.	
7	List a few benefits of ecotourism to local communities.		[K] / [CO4, CO5]
		Ecotourism provides local communities with benefits such as increased income through jobs like guiding and hospitality, which helps fight poverty and encourages the conservation of natural resources.	
8	Which Indian state is famous for its backwaters and house boating activities?		[K] / [CO3]
		Kerala	
			[8x1 = 8]

Part B -Short Essay Type Questions
Answer any 4 out of 6 Questions, Each Question carries 5 marks

9	Explain how adventure sports can contribute to ecotourism.	[U] / [CO3]
	Adventure sports contribute to ecotourism by generating economic benefits for local communities through activities like guided tours, which encourages them to protect the natural environment they rely on. They also promote environmental awareness among participants Economic contribution ➢ Supports local livelihoods: ➢ Creates business opportunities: ➢ Improves living standards: Environmental contribution ➢ Promotes conservation: ➢ Fosters a sense of responsibility: ➢ Funds conservation initiatives: Social and cultural contribution ➢ Encourages cultural exchange: ➢ Increases educational opportunities: ➢ Empowers local communities:	
10	Discuss a protected area, providing an example.	[A] / [CO3]
	A protected area include zoning into core (undisturbed), buffer (controlled activities), and tourism zones; diverse habitats like grasslands, shola forests, and moist deciduous forests; and a focus on conservation for vulnerable species through management plans and initiatives Examples of protected areas in Kerala - **Protected Areas** ; 1, Periyar Tiger Reserve (PTR), ; 2, Neyyar Wildlife Sanctuary, 3, Peechi-Vazhani Wildlife Sanctuary, 4, Parambikulam Wildlife sanctuary **Periyar Tiger Reserve** is a protected area in Kerala known for its hilly terrain, two major rivers (Periyar and Pamba), and the artificial Periyar Lake. Its features include diverse vegetation like tropical evergreen and deciduous forests, and it is a habitat for numerous species, including tigers, elephants, and endemic wildlife. The reserve also has a significant ecotourism program that includes boating, trekking, and camping.	
11	Define hydel tourism.	[K] / [CO1]
	Hydel tourism is a form of special-interest tourism that combines visiting hydropower projects with recreational water-based activities. It involves tourists exploring dams and powerhouses, enjoying activities like boating, river rafting, and kayaking in the surrounding water bodies, and learning about hydroelectric power generation. Core components: Hydel tourism centers are often located at or near hydroelectric power plants and their associated reservoirs, which serve as tourist attractions. Activities: Common activities include tours of the power plant and dam, boating, and other water sports like river rafting and kayaking. Purpose: It serves the dual purpose of providing a unique tourism experience and promoting public awareness about hydroelectric power projects and sustainable energy. Economic and social benefits: It can also generate socio-economic benefits for local communities in remote areas where these projects are located.	
12	Briefly describe the significance of Joint Forest Management (JFM)	(JFM). [U] / [CO4]
	Ecological significance Forest restoration: JFM helps in increasing forest cover and restoring degraded forests. Environmental protection: It leads to improved soil moisture, reduced soil erosion, and enhanced biodiversity. Sustainable use: It provides a framework for managing forest resources sustainably, balancing conservation with the needs of local people.	

		Economic and livelihood significance Income generation: JFM provides access to forest products like timber and non-timber forest products (NTFPs), creating income-generating opportunities through activities like making leaf plates, bamboo crafts, and honey processing. Employment: It creates employment through wage work in forest management and infrastructure projects, as well as through alternative livelihood options. Poverty reduction: By improving livelihoods and providing a share of the benefits from the forest, JFM helps in poverty reduction. Social and empowerment significance Community ownership: It strengthens the sense of community ownership over forests, as local people become active partners in their management and protection. Women empowerment: JFM has a specific focus on empowering women by facilitating their participation in workforce and decision-making, which can lead to more equitable benefit sharing. Institutional strengthening: It strengthens local institutions and creates social structures, such as Self-Help Groups (SHGs), to support the community in managing their resources and skills effectively. Conflict reduction: By involving communities in forest management, JFM helps in reducing conflict between local people and the Forest Department.	
13	Why preliminary assessment important in ecotourism planning.		[U] / [CO4, CO5]
		A preliminary assessment is crucial in ecotourism planning because it helps determine the feasibility and sustainability of a project by evaluating potential environmental impacts, identifying suitable locations, and engaging stakeholders **Reasons for conducting a preliminary assessment:** Ensures feasibility: It determines if an ecotourism project is possible and viable by assessing both the natural and economic potential of an area. Identifies risks and opportunities: Tools like SWOT analysis (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats) can be used to understand a community's readiness for development, identify potential problems, and uncover opportunities for growth. Protects fragile ecosystems: It helps identify and avoid developing in areas that are too fragile to withstand tourism, thereby minimizing negative environmental impacts. Includes community and stakeholders: It involves identifying and engaging all relevant stakeholders, including local communities, to ensure that their needs and concerns are addressed from the outset. **Provides a foundation for sustainable plans**: The information gathered is essential for creating informed, scientifically-based plans that support both conservation and community well-being.	
14	Provide an overview of the famous destinations in Sundarbans ecotourism.		[K] / [CO3]
		Famous ecotourism destinations in the Sundarbans include Sundarbans National Park, known for wildlife viewing like the Royal Bengal Tiger; Sajnekhali Watchtower for birdwatching; Pirkhali, a serene area for boat tours and wildlife spotting; and Henry Island, which offers a beach and mangrove experience. Travelers can also visit Sagar Island, known for the Gangasagar Mela, and engage with local culture and unique fishing methods. Sundarbans National Park - The core of the Sundarbans ecosystem and a UNESCO World Heritage Site, a dense mangrove forest and wildlife reserve. Wildlife, including the Royal Bengal Tiger, spotted deer, and estuarine crocodiles. Sajnekhali Watchtower - A watchtower located within a wildlife sanctuary. Excellent spot for birdwatching, with opportunities to see species like kingfishers, plovers, and pelicans. Pirkhali : A tranquil and beautiful area known for its rich biodiversity. A peaceful destination for nature lovers to spot wildlife like tigers, deer, and birds. Henry Island - An island with a beautiful beach and dense mangrove woods. Explore the beach and the diverse	

		flora in the mangrove forest. Combines beach activities with the unique experience of its mangrove environment. Sagar Island - A large island in the Bay of Bengal. Famous for Gangasagar Mela, a major religious festival held there. Primarily for the cultural significance of the Gangasagar Mela and its religious importance.	
			[4x5 = 12]

Part C- Essay Type Questions
Answer any 1 Question, Each Question carries 10 marks

15	Discuss the eco-friendly practices commonly found in ecotourism centers.		[U] / [CO1]
		Eco-friendly ecotourism centers commonly implement practices like using renewable energy, managing waste responsibly through recycling and reduction, conserving water, and constructing eco-lodges with minimal environmental impact. They also focus on conservation through guided tours, educating visitors on local ecosystems, and ensuring that tourism benefits local communities economically and culturally. **Environmental and infrastructure practices** ❖ Renewable energy: Utilizing solar, wind, or other renewable sources for power and using energy-efficient appliances and lighting. ❖ Waste management: Implementing strong policies for waste reduction, separation, and recycling, and discouraging single-use plastics. ❖ Water conservation: Implementing water-saving measures and rainwater harvesting systems. ❖ Sustainable construction: Building accommodations that blend into the natural environment and minimize impact, often using local, sustainable materials. ❖ Low-impact transportation: Providing and encouraging the use of low-impact transportation like walking, cycling, or public transit for getting around. **Visitor and community practices** ❖ Conservation and education: Educating visitors on the importance of conservation, local wildlife, and respecting habitats. This includes following marked trails and not disturbing animals. ❖ Local economic benefits: Ensuring a significant portion of the revenue from tourism goes directly to the local community and supporting local businesses and services. ❖ Cultural respect: Encouraging respectful interactions with local culture, such as respecting customs, modesty in dress, and asking permission before taking photos. ❖ Visitor management: Using visitor management plans and guiding visitors to prevent overcrowding and minimize negative impacts. **Operational and policy practices** ❖ Responsible operators: Choosing and supporting tour operators and accommodations that are committed to sustainability and community well-being. ❖ Community involvement: Involving local communities in decision-making and ensuring they are empowered and benefit fairly from tourism. ❖ Conservation funding: Directing revenue towards the conservation and management of natural areas.	
16	Illustrate the role of NGOs in ecotourism.		[An] / [CO2]
		NGOs play a crucial role in ecotourism by acting as facilitators, advocates, and capacity builders to ensure sustainability. They achieve this through community empowerment, conservation efforts, policy advocacy, and raising awareness among local communities and tourists. NGOs also provide financial and technical support, bridge the gap between communities and governments, and conduct research to inform responsible tourism development.	

		Key roles of NGOs in ecotourism **Community empowerment**: NGOs help local communities develop ecotourism projects by providing technical and financial support, building their capacity, and ensuring they are active participants in the decision-making process. This helps preserve cultural heritage and creates a more equitable distribution of benefits. **Conservation and environmental protection**: NGOs implement conservation initiatives, promote eco-friendly practices, and conduct research to mitigate the negative environmental impacts of tourism. They may also be involved in managing conservation areas or reserves where ecotourism takes place. **Policy advocacy and governance**: NGOs advocate for responsible ecotourism policies and work with governments to develop and implement regulations that balance economic growth with environmental and social integrity. They often represent local communities in government committees and can lobby for stronger environmental laws. **Awareness and education**: NGOs raise awareness about environmental issues and the principles of ecotourism among both local communities and tourists. This can include educational programs, campaigns, and the development of interpretive materials to enhance the visitor experience and encourage responsible behavior. **Bridging gaps**: NGOs act as a crucial link between different stakeholders, including local communities, governments, and the private sector. They can mobilize resources, facilitate partnerships, and help reconcile competing interests to ensure that ecotourism projects are sustainable and beneficial for all involved.
		[1x10 = 10]